



burning calories. If it's more running that you want, you can run on a treadmill, perhaps adjusting the gradient so you can walk "uphill." Other gym equipment that will give you a good cardio workout—one that raises your heart rate, which is good for burning calories—includes stationary bikes, rowing machines, elliptical walkers (also called cross trainers), and stair masters.

Gyms offer a range of strength and resistance training equipment, too. These build muscle and strengthen bones, so helping to guard against osteoporosis. Different machines are designed to work different parts of the body, and you can also work with free weights and kettlebells.

Join a class

If you're ready to take your freestyle dancing, aerobics, or boxing to the next level, joining a class is the way to go. Dance classes come in many shapes and forms, from ballroom, to salsa,

Boxing is becoming more and more popular with women. Boxing with a sparring partner or a punching bag will burn an average 165 calories per 15 minutes.

to hip-hop. They're great fun and a good way to meet people. Alternatively, go along with a group of friends and burn calories together.

There are also many styles of aerobics classes, but all involve doing routines to music. As you'll have discovered, this is great for helping your motivation and coordination.

And last but by no means least, there are gyms devoted solely to boxing and boxing training. After your 15 minute "taster" you may feel you want to get some boxing gloves on and start punching something. Or you might want to try kickboxing classes—similar to boxing, but using martial arts-style kicks, which give you a good lower body workout, as well as burning lots of calories.